

Pitching Is Key--

Miner Nine Opens In 2 Short Weeks

Official opening day on the diamonds for the U.T. El Paso Miners was only two weeks away and the way they are working out it would almost seem as if it were tomorrow.

The schedule was released today by Miner coach Andy Cohen, whose baseballers open Feb. 27 against Odessa Junior College.

In all, the Miners will play 48 games. The season will continue through May 16. The schedule has four games with NCAA baseball champ Arizona State.

ALTHOUGH THE WESTERN Athletic Conference is well balanced in personnel and tough opponents, the Miners have added two outings with Texas Tech.

Cohen said during practice yesterday, "Our whole season will depend on the pitching of our ball club. We feel if our pitching is on we're going to be respectable."

ON THE returning list of pitchers are Harry Milner, MARC Bombard, Larry Smith, Ernie Carreon, Bill Diselhorse and Don Wilson. On the eligible list for the first time is Ysleta star Jim Greggerson. Also trying out are Pete Ulloa, Joe Donahue, Adolph Varela, Bill Brandt and Daryle Weyman.

The other major factor in a fine season for the Miners will be the stick. Cohen said, "Our batting overall is improved from last year, but we will miss Ron Hicks' and Mike Ward's bat."

Cohen hopes this slack can be picked up with the lumber of Rick Butler, Johnny Miller, Juan Sandoval and newcomer Larry Nemoto.

DATE	OPPONENT	GAMES
Feb. 27	Odessa Jr.	2
Feb. 28	Ranger J.C.	2
Mar. 4	New Mexico	1
Mar. 7	New Mexico	1
Mar. 13	at Texas Tech	2
Mar. 14	Univ. of Colorado	2
Mar. 17	So. Colo. State	1
Mar. 18	Univ. of Colorado	1
Mar. 19	Colorado State Coll.	1
Mar. 20	Colorado State Coll.	1
Mar. 21	Denver	1
Mar. 22	Colorado State Univ.	1
Mar. 23	Regis	2
Mar. 24	Regis	2
Mar. 25	N.M. Highlands	1
Mar. 26	N.M. Highlands	1
Apr. 3	Arizona	1
Apr. 4	N.M. State	2
Apr. 10	at Arizona State	2
Apr. 11	at Arizona State	2
Apr. 12	at Arizona State	2
Apr. 13	at Arizona	1
Apr. 14	New Mexico	2
Apr. 15	at Arizona	2
May 1	New Mexico	2
May 2	at N.M. State	2
May 3	Arizona State	1
May 4	Arizona State	2
May 5	at New Mexico	2
May 6	at New Mexico	2

Kuhn Hires Baseball Protector

NEW YORK (UPI) — Baseball commissioner Bowie Kuhn announced the hiring of former FBI agent Henry A. Fitzgibbon to a fulltime job of investigating professional gambling and other security matters in the major leagues.

Kuhn had said in January he was looking for a director of security for baseball to patrol all 24 teams in the big leagues.

He selected Fitzgibbon, who worked with the FBI for 26 years before retiring from the agency in 1966. Kuhn said Fitzgibbon has extensive experience in the administrative and investigating fields.

KUHN DENIED the employment of Fitzgibbon was inspired by the current federal probe into sports gambling. He said there has been no indication from the Justice Department that the inquiry involves baseball.

"Baseball has been clean and we want to keep it that way," Kuhn said.

After retiring from the FBI, Fitzgibbon joined the St. Louis Police Department as commander of the Bureau of Services. He has been on the lecturing staff of the International Police Academy, has authored numerous papers on law enforcement, and has served as a member of the organized crime committee of the International Assn. of Chiefs of Police.

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